

3 Handheld Gaming consoles

3.1 PlayStation Portable

Video game consoles have not always been about a huge bulking mass that sits next to your television set. Handheld video games have been a great source of novelty and entertainment since the era of the massively popular Tetris right up to the modern age's Nintendo GameBoy.

Gaming has been about portability for a long time now, and with the advent of mobile phones, it became even more so. The idea of playing a quick game while you are travelling to school, college or office was enticing. But cell phones, given their limitations, obviously did not offer a great gaming experience.

With the success that the PlayStation 2 was seeing, Sony was ready to move on to the next big venture. By 2003, the hardware that went into the original PlayStation had become miniaturised to the extent that it could be fit into a tiny form factor that could be held in one's hands. There was an opportunity here and Sony wasn't going to let go.

On 12 December 2004, the Sony PlayStation Portable (PSP) first went on sale in Japan, quickly selling over 2,00,000 units on the first day. The mega-hit console has gone on to have quite a few variations from that first base model and is considered an "essential commodity" for serious gamers.

3.1.1 HARDWARE

Design

The responsibility of designing the PlayStation Portable fell on Sony's Shin'ichi Ogasawara, and what a wonderful job he did with it. The PSP is a flat, candybar



The flat, candybar device is quite chic to look at and a treat to use, ushering in the era of high-end graphics in handheld gaming